

Botany short course 2026

Flowers

Max Carter-Brown

Anglia Ruskin University

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- Reproductive organ of the Angiosperms
- Evolutionarily derived from leaves
- Contain the megaspores (ovaries) and microspores (pollen)
- Much variation but exist as 3-4 'whorls'

Flower characters you will classify

- Sepals (or calyx)

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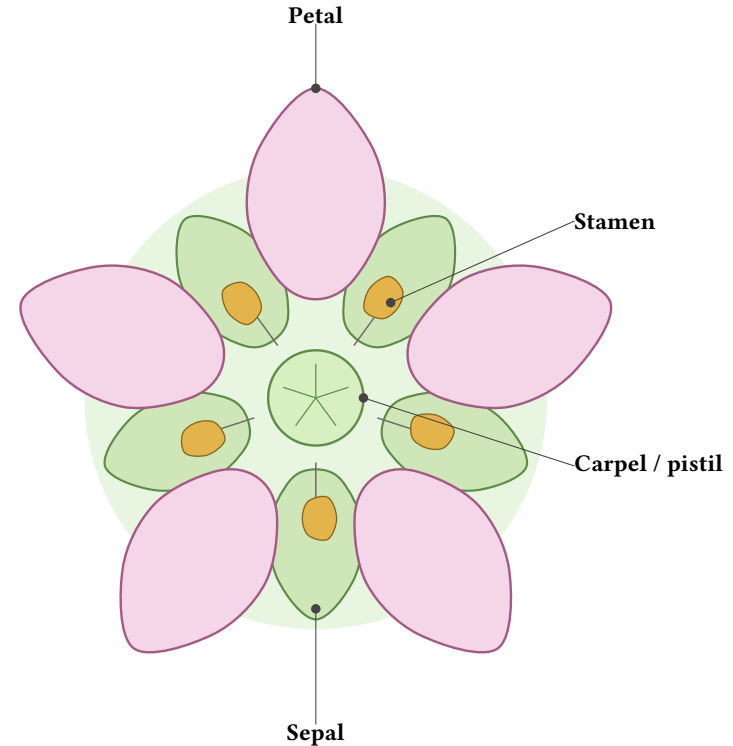
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- Petals (or corolla); tepals
(undifferentiated perianth)

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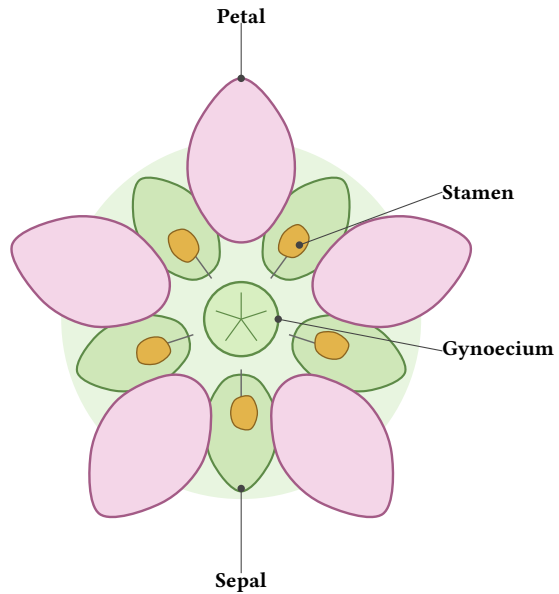
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- Petals (or corolla); tepals
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- Stamens (anthers + filament;
androecium)

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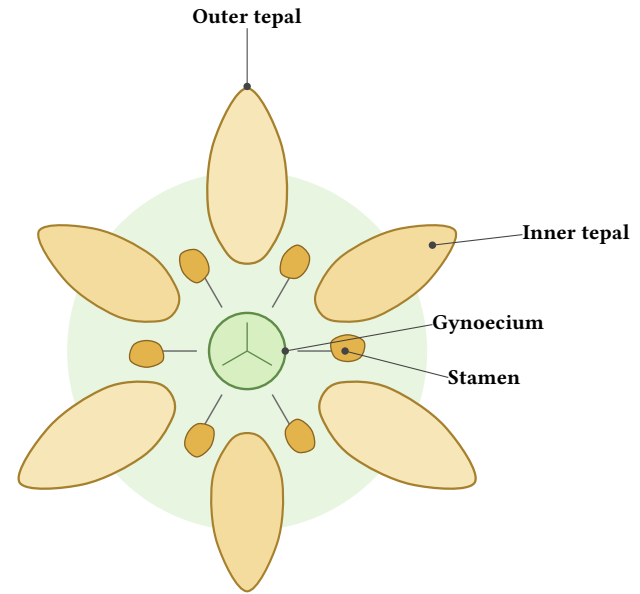
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- Petals (or corolla); tepals (undifferentiated perianth)
- Stamens (anthers + filament; androecium)
- Carpels (ovary + style + stigma; pistil)



Idealised flower top view

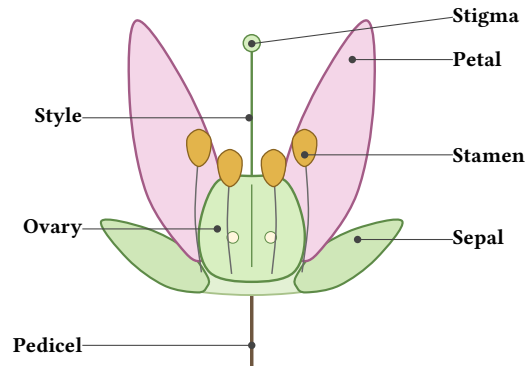


Idealised dicot flower (top view)

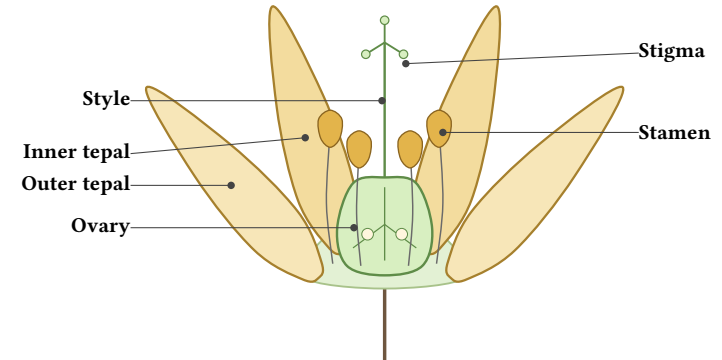


Idealised monocot flower (top view)

Idealised flower cross-section

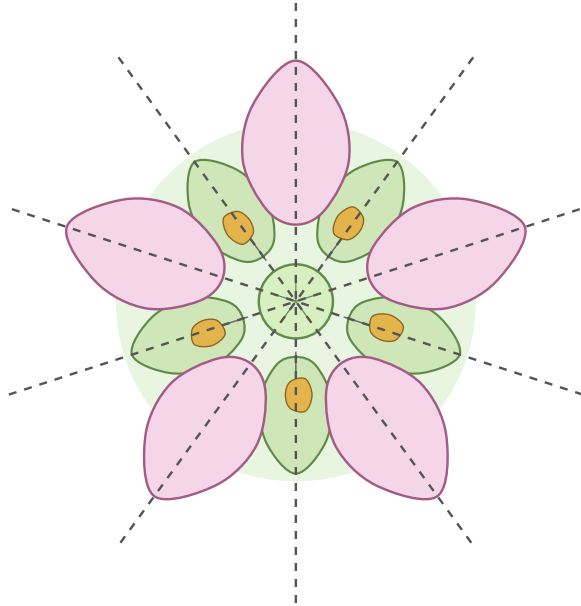


Idealised dicot flower

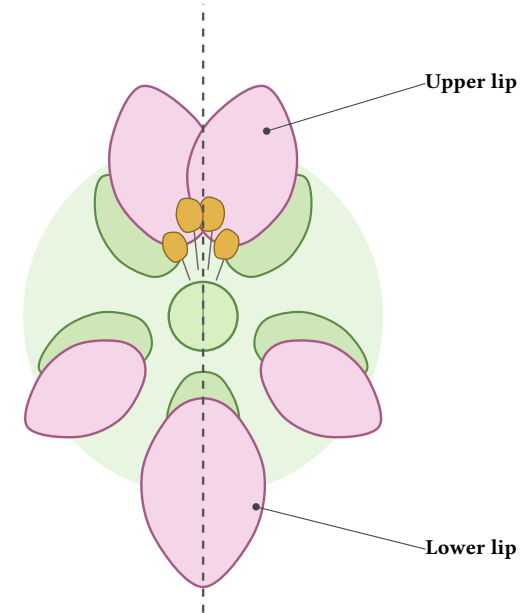


Idealised monocot flower

Floral symmetry



Actinomorphic — radially symmetrical
e.g. *Ranunculus*, *Rosa*



Zygomorphic — bilaterally symmetrical
e.g. *Lamium*, *Digitalis*

Exercise

- I have some flowers here
- Organise into group based on morphology
- Count the floral parts if you can!